

Red Team Lifecycle & OPSEC

The lifecycle (long-form)

1. Kickoff: goals, RoE, contact sheet, kill words
2. Recon: OSINT, phishing enumerations, drive-by candidates
3. Initial access: the phish/lure/cred shot
4. Establish: beacon, validate control-plane
5. Expand: privesc, lateral, approach objectives
6. Objective action: simulate data access (sandboxed/tagged), screenshots
7. Persistence-simulation (if asked): leave a 'red team owned' marker (north)
8. Cleanup: remove artifacts, restore configs, confirm RoE compliance
9. Report + debrief with blue (timeline of detection wins/losses)

OPSEC ground rules

One identity per channel; message-splitting; no cross-links

Keep a *separate* operator account stack from anything personal

Blunders: posting screenshots with usernames, using corp auth for testing

Log everything (for the report), but compress sensitive detail

Measure twice, clean once

Every artifact cataloged & removed; configs returned; accounts disabled

'Red team owned' flags deleted (they're NOT your trophies to leave)

Confirm with blue: nothing extra left behind

Reporting: the blue-kiss

The report structure:

Executive: engagement goal + whether detection worked
Narrative: the chain (recon→access→objective) with timestamps
Detection log: when did blue notice? what fired/not?
Gaps: specific detection/blindspot findings with fixes
Action items: prioritized, owned, dated

A pro red team measures victory by the *lessons blue gains*, then cleans the battlefield completely. Unclean teams poison their own engagement.

[← Command & Control Frameworks](#)

[Adversary Emulation: Build a C...](#)